

Nino Sekeleni

Creative Direction • Art Direction • Brand Strategy • Campaign Development
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Portfolio: ninosekeleni.github.io/Portfolio

Professional Summary

Creative Director and Senior Art Director with ~10 years of experience leading brand strategy, visual systems, and omnichannel campaigns across sport, fintech, and entertainment. Proven record directing multidisciplinary teams from brief to market-ready execution, with recent campaigns spanning Visa's global sports platforms (Paris 2024 Olympics, AFCON, FIFA World Cup) and Cricket South Africa. Adept at translating complex business objectives into compelling creative narratives, managing multi-market toolkits at scale, and measuring impact through brand lift, CAC, LTV, and ROAS. Two-time contributor to the Hollard Sport Industry Award for Sport Organisation of the Year (Lions Cricket, 2023 and 2024).

Core Competencies

Creative Leadership: Creative direction, concept development, multi-channel storytelling, team coaching, pitching, production oversight, quality assurance, impact measurement
Design & Art Direction: Visual systems, brand identity, design systems, UI/UX prototyping, motion basics, production design, accessibility, handoff
Marketing & Performance: Campaign orchestration, performance analysis (CAC/LTV/ROAS), CRO, SEO fundamentals, paid media optimisation, stakeholder communication, executive reporting
Brand Management: Brand positioning, messaging governance, GTM planning, social listening, partnership management, cross-functional alignment, KPI tracking

Work Experience

Creative Lead — Senior Art Director & Creative Strategist Migration | May 2022 – Present

Lead creative direction and campaign development across digital, social, print, and experiential channels. Partner with strategy and account teams to translate business objectives into concepts and finished assets. Direct designers and content creators across the full project lifecycle from brief to delivery.

Key Achievements

- Visa (EMEA & Global): Developed pitch and partnership decks for leading financial institutions across Southern Africa and EMEA, shaping narrative frameworks, visual systems, and data storytelling. Led creative execution across Visa's global sports platforms — Paris 2024 Olympics, AFCON, and the FIFA World Cup — delivering toolkits, social content, out-of-home, experiential activations and localised partner market adaptations.
- Cricket South Africa (Proteas): Conceptualised and launched the Woza Nawe brand campaign; built the visual identity system and asset toolkit to sustain ongoing rollouts. Managed Proteas social media end-to-end across multiple international tours and two ICC 50-over World Cups (Men's & Women's).
- Lions Cricket & Wanderers Stadium: Led brand and campaign creative across four consecutive seasons. Work directly contributed to the club being named Sport Organisation of the Year at the Hollard Sport Industry Awards in both 2023 and 2024.

Senior & Lead Multimedia Designer BET.CO.ZA | June 2021 – May 2022

Led creation of on-brand, performance-focused creative assets for social channels and on-site placements including home, sportsbook, casino, and promotional pages. Partnered with marketing, product, trading, and compliance teams to translate campaigns and odds-led moments into conversion-ready visuals.

Creative & Social Media Lead Soccer Laduma & KICKOFF | September 2018 – May 2021

Joined the social team to build and scale Soccer Laduma and KickOff's multi-platform presence while supporting core editorial products (newspaper and magazine). Owned content planning, creation, scheduling, and copywriting — collaborating end-to-end with editors, designers, and video teams to grow audience and drive engagement and sales.

Key Achievements

- Audience Growth: Grew combined social following from ~500K to ~4M over the tenure (8x increase; +3.5M followers) through high-frequency, insight-led content and rigorous publishing cadences.
- New Platform Launch: Co-created and launched the Soccer Laduma Podcast — covering format design, naming, artwork, guest booking, episode packaging, and distribution — expanding the brand's reach into audio and video audiences.
- Editorial Production: Supported the Soccer Laduma newspaper and KickOff magazine with layout design, page flow, image editing, headline hierarchy, and deadline operations alongside the head editor.

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Work Experience cont.

Storyboard Artist

Strika Entertainment (Contract) | November 2017 – September 2018

Adapted the iconic South African Supa Strikas comic IP into animation-ready storyboards — including beat boards, shot design, character timing, and performance — working with an international production partner and delivering to Disney XD broadcast standards.

Production Assistant Intern

Tshedza Media (Internship) | March 2016 – June 2017

Supported end-to-end production operations including shoot schedule coordination, call sheet preparation, equipment sourcing and tracking, and on-set liaison across departments (ADs, camera, sound, wardrobe) to keep productions on time and within budget.

Education

BA in Motion Picture Medium (NQF Level 7)

AFDA — The South African School of Motion Picture and Live Performance | 2012 – 2015
Specialisation: Media Production

BA Honours in Motion Picture Medium (NQF Level 8)

AFDA — The South African School of Motion Picture and Live Performance | 2015 – 2016
Specialisation: Media Production & Technology

Awards & Recognition

Sport Organisation of the Year

Hollard Sport Industry Awards, Lions Cricket (2023 & 2024): Co-led award submission strategy, coordinated evidence packs and creative assets, and elevated the brand's social presence through campaign planning, content calendars, and stakeholder alignment.

Tools & Technology

- **Design & Creative:** Adobe Photoshop • Adobe Illustrator • Adobe InDesign • Adobe Premiere Pro • Figma • Canva • Frame.io
- **AI & Generative Tools:** Adobe Firefly • Midjourney • ChatGPT (Open AI) • Claude (Anthropic) • Runway ML • Google AI Studio (Nano Banana) • Kling AI • Sora
- **Presentation & Docs:** Keynote • PowerPoint • Google Slides • Google Workspace
- **Paid Media & Advertising:** Google Ads • Meta Ads Manager • TikTok Ads Manager • LinkedIn Campaign Manager • Twitter/X Ads • YouTube Studio • Google Analytics 4 • Meta Business Suite
- **Social Media & Publishing:** Hootsuite • Buffer • Sprout Social • Creator Studio • TikTok Business Suite • Meta Business Suite
- **Project Management & Workflow:** Asana • Slack • Monday.com • Dropbox • Google Drive

I'm most at home turning strategy into clear, standout creative, leading teams, shaping systems and shipping work people remember. Having worked across sport, entertainment and corporate, I bring the range and restraint to elevate your brand and hit business goals.

I'd love to explore how I can help.

Thank you for your consideration.